

Booking hacks with AI copilots

The travel industry is using LLMs under the hood:

- Google Flight Deals uses AI to interpret natural-language queries and match them with live flight data for flexible travelers.
- Booking.com's AI Trip Planner uses OpenAI models to help guests explore destinations and narrow choices faster.
- Expedia's AI planning tools are now powered in part by Perplexity-style answers, combining conversational search with instant booking.
- In India, MakeMyTrip is integrating Gemini, Vertex AI and Maps in its assistant "Myra" to streamline discovery and bookings.

How to use this in practice:

1. Start broad in Gemini / Search AI Mode or the OTA's AI chat:
"I want round-trip flights from [city] to [region] for ~7 days in [month], flexible by ±3 days, budget economy, prioritise fewer layovers and reasonable timings. Show 4–5 good options and tell me which dates look cheapest overall."
2. Ask AI follow-ups like a human agent:
"Which of these options has the shortest total travel time?"
"If I left 2 days later, how much could I save?"
3. Once you have target dates and routes, you can:
 - Set price alerts in traditional tools (Google Flights, MakeMyTrip, Skyscanner)
 - Ask ChatGPT/Gemini:
"Remind me in 2 weeks to re-check flights on these routes and dates to see if prices dropped."
(Depending on product availability, this may use ChatGPT's Tasks/agents or your phone assistant for reminders.)

Ask AI for "travel hacks for this specific route"

Instead of generic tips, get route-specific hacks:

"I'm flying from [city] to [city] via [hub]."

1. Any known airport quirks or tips (transit times, food options, lounge hacks, common delays)?
2. Which seat types are best on [airline + aircraft] for comfort?
3. Any visa/immigration queues or forms I should anticipate as an Indian traveller?"

Perplexity is good at pulling recent traveller experiences and official info together in one answer.

4. Language translation and cultural dos/don'ts

Nothing kills a travel high like accidentally being rude or completely lost in translation.

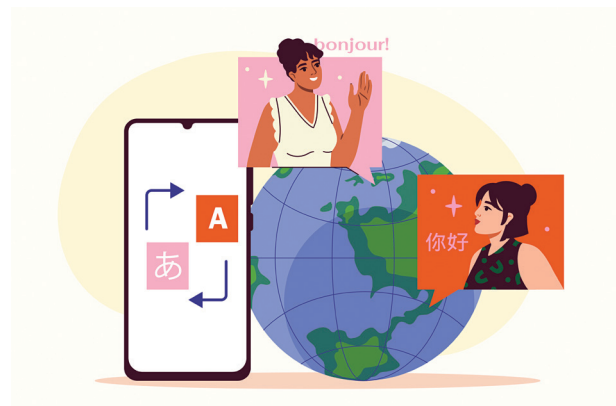
Gemini / Translate / camera for real-time language support

Google is pushing Gemini into a multimodal assistant: you

can type, talk or use your camera to get help, and on Android you can invoke it with "Hey Google" for whatever is on screen.

Typical uses on a trip:

- Point your camera at a menu/sign → ask Gemini/Translate: "What does this say? Any dishes you recommend for a vegetarian?"
- Screenshot a location in Maps → "Is this neighbourhood safe to walk at night?"
- Type a phrase:
"How do I politely say in [language]:
'Excuse me, I don't speak [language] well. Could you please help me find this address?'"
Save a mini list of such phrases in your notes app or offline in Translate.



Cultural etiquette briefing

Before you land, get a culture cheat-sheet:

"Give me a local etiquette guide for [country/city], aimed at a first-time visitor from India.

Cover:

- Greetings
- Tipping norms
- Public transport behaviour
- Dress expectations in religious or formal places
- Common scams or tourist mistakes to avoid
- 3–5 phrases in [language] that locals appreciate."

Ask Gemini or Perplexity so you also see sources (tourism boards, expat blogs, etc.).

Sensitive-scenario role-play

If you're anxious about certain interactions:

"Role-play you are a hotel receptionist in [country]. I'm checking in and want to:

- Ask politely for an early check-in if available
- Clarify if breakfast is included
- Request a quiet room